

Publicis Groupe S.A.

Recommendation **STRONG BUY** ★★★★★

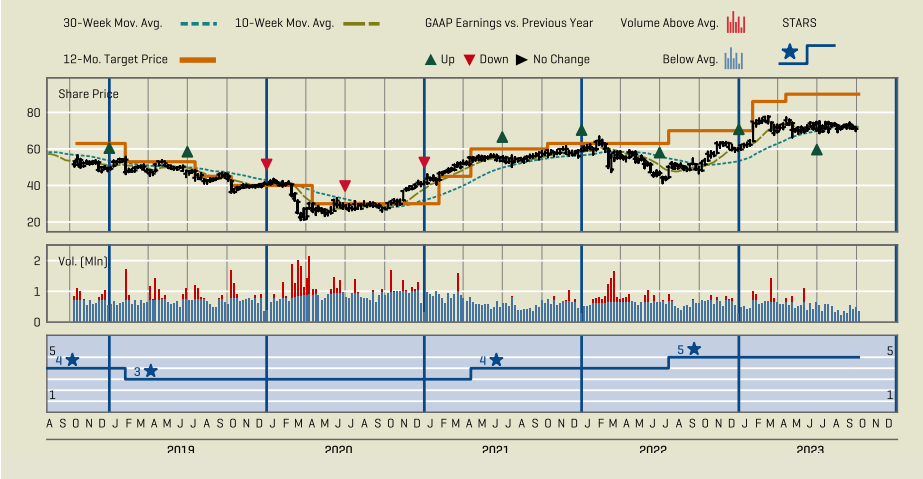
Price EUR 71.86 [as of market close Oct 06, 2023] **12-Mo. Target Price** EUR 90.00 **Report Currency** EUR **Investment Style** Large-Cap Blend

Equity Analyst Danny Yeo Sze Wai, CFA

GICS Sector Communication Services **Sub-Industry** Advertising **Summary** Publicis provides advertising and communications services, from traditionally integrated and multimedia advertising to integrated digital and data services.

Key Stock Statistics (Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports)							
52-Wk Range	EUR 77.94 - 51.42	Oper.EPS2023E	EUR 6.60	Market Capitalization[B]	EUR 18.0	Beta	1.25
Trailing 12-Month EPS	EUR 5.15	Oper.EPS2024E	EUR 7.00	Yield [%]	4.04	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]	13
Trailing 12-Month P/E	13.96	P/E on Oper.EPS2023E	10.89	Dividend Rate/Share	EUR 2.9	SPGMI's Quality Ranking	B
EUR 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	16,749.0	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	251.00	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	EUR 2.9	Institutional Ownership [%]	58.0

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by **Danny Yeo Sze Wai, CFA** on Jul 20, 2023 05:33 AM ET, when the stock traded at **EUR 74.64**.

Highlights

- Publicis (PUB) reported H1 2023 net revenue of EUR6.3bln, slightly above S&P Capital IQ consensus at EUR6.2bln. Q2 2023 organic growth of 7.1% was driven by broad-based growth across all geographical regions, led by Europe at 15.2%, while Asia Pacific was the lowest at 2.6% due to tougher comparative after phasing of large project in Thailand. Organic growth in China accelerated to 7.0% (Q1 2023: 3.7%); however, we see difficulty in following up with sustained growth in view of macro challenges in China. Digital transformation remains central in PUB's growth strategy as Epsilon grew 6.9%.
- Operating margin maintained at 17.3% in H1 2023 due to savings from non-personnel costs of -30 bps to 16.2% of net revenue. This was offset by an expansion in personnel costs by 30 bps to 66.5% of net revenue. Guidance for 2023 is now upgraded to 5.0% for organic growth (from 3.0-5.0%) and operating margin to c.18.0% (from 17.5-18.0%). The upgrade is a positive, but not surprising, as it is within our expectation. However, we think this should prompt the lifting of consensus figures, which currently pegs PUB's growth at c.4.0%, according to S&P Capital IQ.
- We leave our EPS forecasts unchanged.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- Our recommendation is 5-STARs (Strong Buy). We believe PUB will be able to maintain industry leadership as seen from its growth outperformance, further solidified by its digital business transformation, which has complemented its existing traditional creative and media segments well. Its digital businesses are able to capture the shift in advertising spending from traditional advertising (billboards, television, radio, cinema) to personalized and targeted digital marketing (third-party cookies, first-party data) via the use of the digital ecosystem that PUB provides. PUB has demonstrated its ability to attract new businesses historically, and this will continue to be supported by the need to transform the existing marketing and business model for its clients amid the current dynamic environment.
- Key downside risks to our recommendation and target include significant and meaningful contract losses, and an inability to catch up with technology resulting in technological obsolescence.
- Our 12-month target price for PUB is EUR90. This reflects a 2023 P/E of 13.6x, which is a slight premium against its three-year average P/E of 13.0x, justified, in our opinion, by its stronger growth prospects.

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW **MEDIUM** **HIGH**

The group is reliant on global advertising expenditure, which has a cyclical nature. However, the group's diversified geographical and industry exposure somewhat balances out its risk profile. Data and technology form c.33% of group revenue, representing a healthy revenue mix with exposure to high growth segments.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million EUR)	1H	2H	Year
2024	--	--	E 13,800
2023	7,105	--	E 13,326
2022	5,873	6,699	12,572
2021	4,931	5,556	10,487
2020	4,774	4,938	9,712
2019	4,352	5,448	9,800

Earnings Per Share (EUR)

	1H	2H	Year
2024	--	--	E 7.00
2023	2.46	--	E 6.60
2022	2.15	2.72	4.87
2021	1.68	2.45	4.13
2020	0.57	1.83	2.40
2019	1.49	2.10	3.59

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount [EUR]	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
2.9000	Feb 02	Jul 03	Jul 04	Jul 05 '23
2.4000	Feb 03	Jul 04	Jul 05	Jul 06 '22
2.0000	Feb 03	Jun 15	Jun 16	Jul 06 '21
1.1500	Apr 15	Sep 07	Sep 08	Sep 28 '20
2.1200	Apr 17	Jun 25	Jun 26	Jul 23 '19
2.0000	Apr 20	Jun 06	Jun 05	Jul 04 '18

Dividends have been paid since 2001 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.
Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance. Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.

Publicis Groupe S.A.

Business Summary Jul 20, 2023

CORPORATE OVERVIEW: Founded in 1926 by Marcel Bleustein-Blanchet, the company’s name originates from the combination of Publi, for Publicite, which means advertising in French, and “six” for 1926. The founder’s ambition was to transform advertising into a true profession with social value, applying a rigorous methodology and ethics, and to make Publicis a “pioneer of modern advertising.” Publicis Groupe is the world’s third-largest communications group with operations in over 100 countries and over 98,000 employees. The group provides advertising and communication services to national and multinational clients. It offers advertising services that principally involve the creation of advertising for products, services, and brands, as well as strategic planning, including analysis of a product, service, or brand compared to its competitors through market research, sociological and psychological studies, and insight.

GROUP STRUCTURE: To adapt to the threats of new media companies and the rise of the digital giants, Publicis Groupe aims to reinvent itself as a platform via its Power of One plan in 2016. Since then, the group transformed its business model and its organizational structure to put its clients at the center and to facilitate access to all its services in a fluid, modular way. Today, Publicis’ offer is based on four main areas of expertise: Communication, Media, Data, and Technology. Publicis Communications (Publicis Worldwide with MSL, Saatchi & Saatchi, Leo Burnett, BBH, and Prodigious), Publicis Sapient (Sapient Consulting, SapientNitro, DigitasLBi, Razorfish); Publicis Media (Starcom MediaVest, ZenithOptimedia, and VivaKi); and Publicis Health (Digitas Health, Discovery USA, HeartBeat, insync).

Publicis Communications is the indispensable creative partner to its clients in their own transformation by delivering seamless access to the creative firepower of its networks through end-to-end platforms linking consumer insight, brand knowledge, and creative ideas, boosted by data and technology. Publicis Media drives value for clients through four global media agency brands and scaled capabilities across investment, strategy, insights and analytics, data and technology, performance marketing, and content. Publicis Sapient is the company’s digital arm, where it helps clients adapt and transform in a digitally disrupted environment. Publicis Sapient integrates Publicis Groupe’s know-how in the creative space to create solutions across all distribution channels and services based on its technological prowess. Following the acquisition of Epsilon in 2019, which further strengthened the group’s data expertise, on March 30, 2023 Publics announced the acquisition of Practia to further expand its digital business transformation segment. Practia is one of Latin America’s leading independent technology companies and provider of digital business transformation services. On June 15, 2023, the company launched its JV with Carrefour to address the booming retail media market in Europe, Brazil, and Argentina.

MARKET PROFILE: In 2022, 63% of Publicis Groupe’s revenues came from North America, 23% from Europe, 9% from Asia-Pacific, and the rest from Latin America and Africa and the Middle East. The group’s net revenue is largely diversified, with 3,298 clients making up 91% of its H1 2023 total net revenue. Although exposure to the automotive industry and finance are largest at 15% respectively, followed by food & beverage and health care at 13%, respectively, the group is still largely diversified with exposure to more than 10 industries.

FINANCIAL TRENDS. Due to the strong recovery in the advertising market, Publicis organic revenue grew 10% to EUR10.5 billion in 2021 after a lull in 2020. 2022 saw even stronger growth at an organic growth rate of 10.1% to EUR12.6 billion, driven by strong data and technology segments, Epsilon [+12.0%] and Publicis Sapient [+18.5%]. Due to its creativity-based business nature, personnel costs remain a key margin determinant. In 2022, personnel cost was up by 200 bps, but was offset by operational efficiencies and the absence of one-time contract costs. Subsequently, operating margin in 2022 improved 50 bps to 18.0%, staying within its target of 17.5%-18.0%. Publicis is paying a dividend of EUR2.90 per share in 2022, corresponding to a dividend payout ratio of 45.7%.

Corporate information

Investor contact

A. Girolami [33 1 44 43 70 00]

Office

133, Avenue des Champs-Élysées, Paris, Ile-de-France, 75008

Telephone

33 1 44 43 70 00

Fax

N/A

Website

www.publicisgroupe.com

Officers

Group General Counsel

C. Fronval

President

A. Bousquet

CFO & Member of Management Board

M. M. Proch

Chairman of Management Board & CEO

A. Sadoun

Board Members

A. Kudelski	R. S. Stoddart
A. Mei-Pochtler	S. Badinter
A. Saber	S. Dulac
J. A. Giuliani	S. Giannino
J. Charest	S. King
M. J. Kravis	S. LeVine
M. Lévy	T. H. Glocer
P. Pénicaud	T. Thiam
P. Velay-Borrini	É. Badinter

Domicile

France

Founded

1926

Employees

101,152

Stockholders

N/A

Auditor

Mazars, Ernst & Young et Autres

Publicis Groupe S.A.

Quantitative Evaluations						
Fair Value Rank	NR	1	2	3	4	5
		LOWEST		HIGHEST		
		Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued (1) to most undervalued (5).				
Fair Value Calculation	N/A					
Volatility	NA	LOW		AVERAGE		HIGH
Technical Evaluation	BULLISH	Since July, 2023, the technical indicators for PUB FP have been BULLISH"				
Insider Activity	NA	UNFAVORABLE		NEUTRAL		FAVORABLE

Expanded Ratio Analysis				
	2022	2021	2020	2019
Price/Sales	1.06	1.27	0.91	0.87
Price/EBITDA	6.35	7.04	5.09	4.80
Price/Pretax Income	9.12	11.09	12.86	8.31
P/E Ratio	12.33	14.51	17.13	11.37
Avg. Diluted Shares Outstg. [M]	253.61	251.70	241.93	236.61
Figures based on fiscal year-end price				
Key Growth Rates and Averages				
Past Growth Rate [%]	1 Year	3 Years	5 Years	
Net Income	18.99	13.26	7.23	
Sales	20.94	8.87	8.75	
Ratio Analysis (Annual Avg.)				
Net Margin [%]	8.61	7.57	7.92	
% LT Debt to Capitalization	18.50	22.91	23.17	
Return on Equity [%]	13.46	11.50	12.17	

Company Financials Fiscal year ending Dec 31										
Per Share Data [EUR]	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013
Tangible Book Value	-16.50	-18.23	-21.62	-26.19	-13.07	-15.99	-19.70	-23.48	-8.79	-9.52
Free Cash Flow	8.84	6.65	11.67	9.01	7.57	6.14	4.02	5.27	4.01	5.81
Earnings	4.82	4.08	2.38	3.55	3.92	3.74	-2.36	3.99	3.16	3.54
Earnings (Normalized)	4.80	3.74	3.11	4.08	3.90	3.98	3.97	3.96	3.16	3.14
Dividends	0.14	0.33	2.00	1.15	2.12	2.00	1.85	1.60	1.20	1.10
Payout Ratio [%]	6.81	22.10	17.71	33.89	22.85	19.72	NM	26.64	15.42	13.64
Prices: High	66.86	61.52	43.70	55.76	63.18	69.00	69.54	79.40	70.37	66.51
Prices: Low	41.15	40.44	20.94	35.98	47.16	52.04	49.94	55.60	49.62	44.66
P/E Ratio: High	13.90	15.10	18.40	15.70	16.10	18.40	NM	19.90	22.30	18.80
P/E Ratio: Low	8.50	9.90	8.80	10.10	12.00	13.90	NM	13.90	15.70	12.60
Income Statement Analysis [Million EUR]										
Revenue	14,196	11,738	10,788	11,001	9,951	9,332	9,733	9,601	7,255	6,953
Operating Income	2,061	1,637	1,394	1,636	1,551	1,544	1,501	1,507	1,193	1,168
Depreciation + Amortization	638.00	733.00	939.00	757.00	595.00	234.00	245.00	263.00	176.00	151.00
Interest Expense	205.00	185.00	262.00	207.00	139.00	101.00	107.00	109.00	48.00	46.00
Pretax Income	1,653	1,343	767.00	1,149	1,215	1,184	-178.00	1,297	1,045	1,107
Effective Tax Rate	26.10	22.90	25.60	26.50	23.50	26.40	-192.10	29.80	29.80	26.90
Net Income	1,222	1,027	576.00	841.00	919.00	862.00	NM	901.00	720.00	792.00
Net Income [Normalized]	1,218	940.40	751.90	964.50	915.90	918.80	887.40	894.40	720.40	704.90
Balance Sheet and Other Financial Data [Million EUR]										
Cash	4,616	3,659	3,700	3,413	3,206	2,407	2,228	1,672	3,158	1,442
Current Assets	19,107	17,127	15,130	15,816	14,434	13,253	13,342	12,585	11,749	9,260
Total Assets	35,898	32,846	30,161	32,659	27,080	23,780	24,896	25,446	20,626	17,110
Current Liabilities	20,389	18,227	16,783	17,946	15,324	14,208	14,598	14,592	12,082	10,776
Long Term Debt	2,989	3,446	3,653	4,286	2,425	2,691	2,927	2,988	1,539	460.00
Total Capital	16,161	14,392	13,901	16,078	11,834	9,116	9,601	10,157	8,317	5,998
Capital Expenditures	198.00	139.00	167.00	232.00	207.00	136.00	173.00	231.00	135.00	126.00
Cash from Operations	2,417	1,792	2,966	2,342	1,942	1,525	1,072	1,405	1,033	1,379
Current Ratio	0.94	0.94	0.90	0.88	0.94	0.93	0.91	0.86	0.97	0.86
% Long Term Debt of Capitalization	18.50	23.90	26.30	26.70	20.50	29.50	30.50	29.40	18.50	7.70
% Net Income of Revenue	8.60	8.70	5.30	7.60	9.20	9.20	-5.40	9.40	9.90	11.40
% Return on Assets	3.75	3.25	2.77	3.42	3.81	3.96	3.73	4.09	3.95	4.33
% Return on Equity	13.50	13.20	7.80	11.80	14.50	14.50	-8.20	14.30	13.10	16.50

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence. Data may be preliminary or restated; before results of discontinued operations/special items. Per share data adjusted for stock dividends; EPS diluted. E-Estimated. NA-Not Available. NM-Not Meaningful. NR-Not Ranked. UR-Under Review.

Publicis Groupe S.A.**Industry Outlook**

We have a neutral 12-month fundamental outlook on EMEA Consumer Discretionary (Ex-Automobiles Components). Despite favorable trading results, in part due to the return of Chinese demand, and stronger economic data, we remain cautious over economic headwinds including the high cost-of-living situation and recessionary risks and tough growth comparables.

For the Apparel, Accessories, and Luxury Goods subsector, we have a neutral outlook. We believe topline performance peaked in 2022 and expect growth to moderate around the return of China demand, sustainability of pricing momentum, and U.S. local sales. High-end luxury companies with strong brand equity will take center stage this year due to the inelasticity of demand for their products and the growing composition of China sales in their regional portfolio (>30%), in our view. We expect to see operating margins returning to pre-pandemic levels from the supply chain recovery and further economies of scale.

We have a neutral outlook on the Apparel Retail subsector. We expect a mixed performance between competitors due to a shift in consumer preference in 2023 towards “quality-and-price” rather than “value-based on-price”, in our view, as consumers begin to tighten their household budget. With expectations of stronger footfall, physical retail is expected to continue to make a return. We think margins will continue to recover as retailers are expected to see further cost savings trickling in from current programs and the absence of one-time costs for the winding up of Russian operations.

We maintain our positive outlook on Casinos and Gaming. The subsector remains a long-term structural play with 2023 expected to be the year of positive EBITDA for U.S. sports betting and e-gaming, particularly in H2. Other regions remain supportive of growth, and we look towards further updates on the progress of legislative agenda in grey markets, particularly Brazil. With the absence of major sporting tournaments this year, we expect to see margins continue to be pressured as marketing spend to support sales remains high.

We turn positive on Hotels, Resorts, and Cruise Lines over expectations of a strong operating environment with strong forward bookings and occupancy close to pre-pandemic levels. We expect the return of Chinese travellers, continued momentum in business travel demand, and supportive leisure travel demand to generate mid-to-high single-digit pricing. Though margins may continue to be impacted by the high cost of labor and energy costs, we believe this is contained by full-service hotels with significant exposure to the luxury market.

Year-to-date through March 31, 2023, the S&P Europe 350 Consumer Discretionary Index was up 16.9%, outperforming the broader S&P Europe 350 Index. This was mainly due to strong performance of the Apparel, Accessories, and Luxury Goods subsector, which rose 22.8% as a solid Q4 results in line with market expectations and indication of a positive start to 2023 as sales momentum returns in China lifted investor sentiments, in our view. Sector valuation remains unattractive as it continues to trade at a hefty 1-year forward P/E valuation of 13x, at +1.5 standard deviation to its 5-year average of 10.5x and above the SPE350 of 11.7x. We find limited upside as we believe this has already priced in stronger investor sentiment for the consumer discretionary sector against a backdrop of recessionary risks and moderating growth from the Covid-19 recovery.

/ Ashman Razak

Sub-Industry: Advertising Peer Group*: Advertising

Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. (M)	30-Day Price Chg. (%)	1-Year Price Chg. (%)	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield (%)	Return on Equity (%)	LTD to Cap (%)
Publicis	PUB FP	ENXTPA	EUR	71.86	18,009.0	-1.2	36.6	14.0	N/A	4.0	14.3	19.9
Informa plc	INF LN	LSE	GBP	7.26	10,002.0	-0.7	33.8	29.0	N/A	1.7	5.1	16.8
Interpublic Group	IPG	NYSE	USD	29.14	11,217.0	-10.1	8.2	11.0	N/A	4.3	26.5	34.1
Omnicom Group	OMC	NYSE	USD	74.25	14,670.0	-7.4	12.8	10.0	N/A	3.8	37.8	53.6
WPP Group	WPP LN	LSE	GBP	7.29	7,794.0	-4.7	-6.3	7.0	N/A	5.4	15.0	37.1

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.

NA- Not Available; NM-Not Meaningful.

Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

Publicis Groupe S.A.**Analyst Research Notes and other Company News****July 20, 2023**

04:34 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Strong Buy Recommendation on Shares of Publicis [PUB FP 74.56*****]:

We leave our 12-month target price for Publicis [PUB] unchanged at EUR90, implying a 2023 P/E of 13.6x, a premium against its 3-year average P/E of 13.0x, justified in our opinion by its stronger growth prospects. PUB reported H1 2023 net revenue of EUR6.3bln, slightly above S&P Capital IQ consensus at EUR6.2bln. Q2 2023 organic growth of 7.1% was driven by broad-based growth across all geographical regions, led by Europe at 15.2%, while Asia Pacific was the lowest at 2.6% due to tougher comparative after phasing of large project in Thailand. Organic growth in China accelerated to 7.0% (Q1 2023: 3.7%); however, we see difficulty in following up with sustained growth in view of macro challenges in China. Nevertheless, PUB's business has proven resilient across all business cycles as the company upgraded its 2023 guidance to organic growth of c.5% from the previous 3-5% range. We are confident in PUB's growth potential and the guidance upgrade is a clear showcase of outperformance. / Danny Yeo Sze Wai, CFA

April 20, 2023

04:57 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Strong Buy Recommendation on Shares of Publicis [PUB FP 76.60*****]:

We raise our 12-month target price for Publicis [PUB] to EUR90 (from EUR86), implying 2023 P/E of 13.6x, a premium against its 3-year average P/E of 13.0x, justified in our view by its stronger growth prospects. We raise 2023 EPS to EUR6.60 (from EUR6.20) and 2024 EPS to EUR7.00 (from EUR6.60). PUB reported Q1 2023 net revenue of EUR3.1bln, slightly above S&P Capital IQ consensus at EUR3.0bln. Organic growth of 7.1% was driven by broad-based growth across all geographical regions. Organic growth in Asia Pacific was the lowest at 0.8%, dragged by phasing of a large project in Thailand. However, China posted positive growth of 3.7%; we expect further growth following a rebound after lifting of pandemic measures. Epsilon's real-time data and Publicis Sapient's technology segment posted organic growth of 10% and 11%, respectively. We expect strong earnings growth to be driven by its transformative data and technology segments, complementing its stable traditional advertising segment. / Danny Yeo Sze Wai, CFA

February 02, 2023

06:01 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Strong Buy Recommendation on Shares of Publicis [PUB FP 69.94*****]:

We raise our 12-month target price for Publicis [PUB] to EUR86 (from EUR70), implying a 2023 P/E of 13.9x, a premium against its 3-year average P/E of 13.0x, justified in our opinion by its industry leading margins. We raise 2023 EPS to EUR6.20 (from EUR5.56) and initiate 2024 EPS at EUR6.60. PUB reported 2022 net revenue of EUR12.6bln, slightly ahead of S&P Capital IQ consensus at EUR12.5bln. Organic growth was 10.1% in 2022 vs. 2021, and 13.0% vs. 2019. The growth was driven by its data and technology arms, Epsilon (+12.0%) and Publicis Sapient (+18.5%), which now represent one-third of its net revenue. Despite the increase in personnel cost [+23.7%], operating margin still improved 50-bps to 18.0% as the lack of one-time cost related to contract renewal more than offset cost increases in 2022. We expect PUB to sustain its operating margin between 17.5% and 18.0% into 2023. Maintain Strong Buy as we see sustained earnings growth from its data and technology capabilities. / Danny Yeo Sze Wai, CFA

October 18, 2022

10:01 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Strong Buy Recommendation on Shares of Publicis [PUB FP 57.70*****]:

We keep our 12-month target price for Publicis [PUB] unchanged at EUR70, implying a 2023 P/E of 12.5x, in line with 3-year average P/E of 12.5x. PUB reported its third consecutive quarter of double-digit organic growth in 3Q 2022 at 10.3% Y/Y. Against pre-pandemic levels in 2019, PUB achieved 16% organic growth, which we attribute to higher marketing expenses by clients after a slowdown in 2020 and 2021. We expect clients' marketing budgets to be sustained through the rest of 2022. Following the momentum in 3Q 2022, PUB upgraded its full-year 2022 guidance for the second time. PUB expects organic growth to be at c.8.5%, with operating margin at c.18%. We believe PUB's diversified profile (3,442 clients with no more than 15% exposure to each major sector) allows it to weather short-term uncertainties. With strong leadership combining creativity and technology, PUB will continue to extract stable revenue from clients looking to expand beyond traditional advertising, in our opinion. / Danny Yeo Sze Wai, CFA

July 22, 2022

12:46 AM ET... CFRA Raises Opinion on Shares of Publicis to Strong Buy from Buy [PUB FP 49.50*****]:

We raise our 12-month target price for Publicis [PUB] to EUR70 (EUR63), implying a 2023 P/E of 12.5x, in line with its 3-year average P/E of 12.6x. PUB's H1 2022 results came in at an all-time high for various financial parameters. We adjust our EPS forecasts to EUR5.07 (EUR5.00) for 2022 and EUR5.56 (EUR5.10) for 2023. Net revenue grew 10.4% Y/Y on an organic basis, implying an 11.3% Y/Y growth versus pre-pandemic levels. After a record number of contract wins in 2021, its continuous momentum led to an operating margin of 17.3% (H1 2021: 16.5%). Solid organic growth reported across all regions with Latin America up 20.7%, Middle East & Africa up 15.3%, North America up 10.3%, Europe up 10.1%, and Asia Pacific up 6.5%. Free cash flow is up strongly to EUR708m (H1 2021: EUR605m), on path to reach targeted annualized free cash flow of at least EUR1.5bln for 2022. PUB's ability to perform strongly during these turbulent times is attractive to us, prompting an upgrade to Strong Buy. / Firdaus Ibrahim, CFA

April 18, 2022

02:19 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Recommendation on Shares of Publicis [PUB FP 55.62*****]:

We retain our Buy opinion on Publicis with the same target price of EUR63, which represents a 2022 P/E of 13x, at its 3-year average forward P/E of 13x. We believe Publicis should trade closer to the higher multiples it has in the past as its current digital-heavy model gives it an edge in winning new business. We retain our 2022 EPS forecast of EUR5.00 and 2023 forecast of EUR5.10. Publicis' Q1 2022 net revenue grew 10.5% organically, above expectations despite the challenging environment. All regions performed well with the U.S. up 8%, Europe up 15%, and Asia up 14% fueled by China. We think Publicis is on track to meet its guidance for organic growth between 4% and 5%, and an operating margin of around 17.5% in 2022 with continued escalation of the war in Ukraine and the Covid-19 situation in China as key risks to the performance. / Adrian Ng, CFA

February 04, 2022

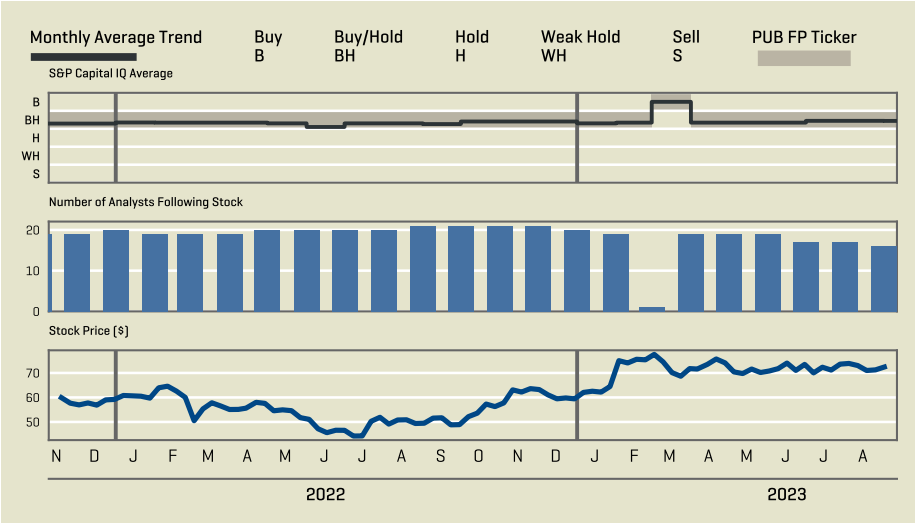
09:27 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Buy Recommendation for Shares of Publicis [PUB FP 56.92*****]:

We retain our Buy opinion on Publicis with the same target price of EUR63, which represents a 2022 P/E of 13x, at its three-year average forward P/E of 13x. We believe Publicis should trade closer to the higher multiples it has in the past, as its current digital-heavy model gives it an edge in winning new business. We retain our 2022 EPS forecast at EUR5.0 and introduce a 2023 forecast of EUR5.1. Publicis' Q4 2021 net revenue grew 9.3% organically taking full year organic growth to 10.0%. 2021 operating income was up 18.1% year-on-year at EUR1,840 million as EBIT margin rose 150bps to 17.5%. The EBIT margin increase can mainly be attributed to the organic growth coupled with lower personnel costs and lower depreciation and amortization. Publicis is guiding for organic growth between 4% to 5% and an operating margin of around 17.5% in 2022. / Adrian Ng, CFA

Note: Research notes reflect CFRA's published opinions and analysis on the stock at the time the note was published. The note reflects the views of the equity analyst as of the date and time indicated in the note, and may not reflect CFRA's current view on the company.

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Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo.Prior	3 Mos.Prior
Buy	7	44	7	7
Buy/Hold	3	19	3	4
Hold	5	31	5	5
Weak hold	0	0	0	0
Sell	1	6	1	1
No Opinion	0	0	0	0
Total	16	100	16	17

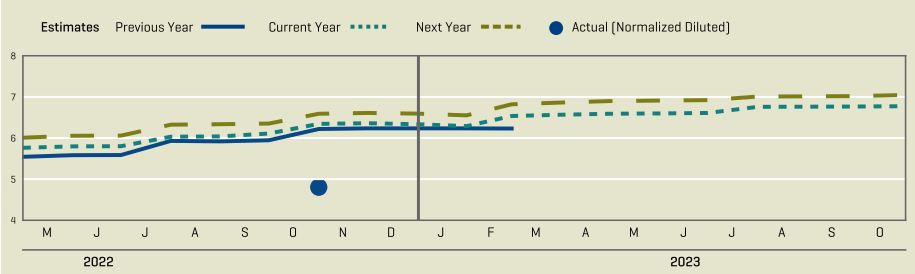
Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Buy/Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that PUB FP will earn EUR 6.77. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that PUB FP's earnings per share will grow by 4.06% to EUR 7.05.

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	7.05	7.28	6.77	15	10.06
2023	6.77	6.87	6.61	15	10.47
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 4%	▲ 6%	▲ 2%	N/A%	▼ -4%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.

Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.

Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

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Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs [American Depositary Receipts], and ADSs [American Depositary Shares] based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS [Stock Appreciation Ranking System], equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark [e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)], based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

[also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**] - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsule the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+ Highest	B Below Average
A High	B- Lower
A Above	C Lowest
B+ Average	D In Reorganization
NC Not Ranked	

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus [average] EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

- CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
- CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
- CY - Calendar Year
- DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
- DDM - Dividend Discount Model
- EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
- EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
- EPS - Earnings Per Share
- EV - Enterprise Value
- FCF - Free Cash Flow
- FFO - Funds From Operations
- FY - Fiscal Year
- P/E - Price/Earnings
- P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
- PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
- PV - Present Value
- R&D - Research & Development
- ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
- ROE Return on Equity
- ROI - Return on Investment
- ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
- ROA - Return on Assets
- SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
- SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
- WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) and American Depositary Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ 5-STARS (Strong Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★★ 4-STARS (Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 3-STARS (Hold):

Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 2-STARS (Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 1-STAR (Strong Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:

In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.



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Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

STARS Stock Reports:

Qualitative STARS rankings are determined and assigned by equity analysts. For reports containing STARS rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of STARS rankings.

Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five [six] model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of September 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	36.8%	34.5%	41.6%	37.4%
Hold	53.8%	51.2%	50.3%	52.6%
Sell	9.4%	14.3%	8.1%	10.1%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

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